The 6:15

SUNDAY · NOVEMBER 1, 2026 NO. 34

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · WEEKEND FORMAT

Today	OPEC+ core-seven review meeting sets December output; outcome **not published this run**.
Next 10 days	Mon 11/2: Palantir Q3 after close (date unconfirmed by one calendar; options imply ~±12% move). Tue 11/3: midterm elections — House/Senate majorities in play (Lead); AMD and Pfizer report, though sources split on whether AMD lands Mon. or Tue. night **(unreconciled)**. Fri 11/6: October jobs report (NFP), 8:30a ET.

No frontier AI release, major rocket launch, or major VC round confirmed this run.

METRICS · WEEKEND FORMAT

Status	Markets closed through today; equities reopen Mon. 11/2, 9:30a ET, futures resume Sun. evening. No new settle since Friday 10/30's close (issue No. 33) — not re-printed here rather than re-adjectived.

HORMUZ COUNTERS · STRAITS.LIVE, 01 NOV 2026, 10:12Z (5:12A ET)

Status	Closed to commercial shipping, Day 245
Transits	Still 2 vessels, Oct. 25 (PortWatch) vs. 85/day baseline — unrevised, 7 days stale
Dark tankers	58 of 142 screened, 24h (40.8%) **(non-tankers also went dark at 33.7% — narrower gap than Friday's 53.8%/44.8%)**
War-risk premium	~32.0x pre-crisis, trade-press est. dated Oct. 7 — 25 days stale, background only
Indices	Crisis Pressure 88±9 (Extreme, flat); Escalation Forecast 59±11 (Elevated, -1)

Methodology: PortWatch counts only AIS-broadcasting crossings and likely understates true flow; the dark-tanker screen measures AIS silence, not interdiction; the war-risk figure is one stale trade-press estimate. None is additive with another — straits.live's "Closed" verdict is a composite judgment, not an average of these three.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Season over. Expected qualifying offer (~$23.15M) to closer David Bednar, not Jazz Chisholm Jr., per NY Post reporting **(single-sourced, unconfirmed)**.
Knicks	Record **still unconfirmed this run** — no game found to resolve the Oct. 29/31 source conflict. Hosts Brooklyn Monday, 7:30p ET.
Northwestern	Lost 34-14 at No. 4 Oregon Saturday — the programs' first-ever meeting.

LEAD

THE DATA PROBLEM BEHIND THE DATA

Two days from the midterms, a fake-polling scandal is complicating the only story left to price

The data underneath Tuesday's midterms took a hit this cycle that has nothing to do with Washington: on Oct. 20, a firm calling itself Wedgewood Polls admitted that nearly all of the polls it had published were fabricated, after the polling aggregator FiftyPlusOne flagged statistical irregularities and contacted the firm on Oct. 19. Wedgewood's own account framed the episode as a deliberate test of how easily a wholly invented polling operation could gain traction with the press and campaign trackers; the New York Times, which had folded 15 Wedgewood polls into its own tracking page, pulled all of them once the admission surfaced. It's the second such case this cycle — an earlier fake firm, Median Strategies, ran a similar stunt on primary-season polling, including a phony read on this year's Wisconsin Democratic gubernatorial primary. Michigan state Sen. Mallory McMorrow has said the fabricated numbers affected her own campaign; a separate former Democratic Senate candidate has made the same claim about her race **(attributed, not independently verified)**.

None of that changes what the real, surviving polling average says, which is why the scandal matters as a credibility problem rather than a data one: PollCheck's aggregate, last updated Oct. 27, has the generic ballot at Democrats 51.1%, Republicans 42.4% — a D+8.7 margin — with Reuters/Ipsos's own Oct. 26 poll of 1,164 likely voters separately putting it at 53%-44%. Trump's approval sits in record-low territory across the cycle, with PollCheck's Oct. 27 average at 34.7% approve, 62.5% disapprove. Both figures are broadly consistent with, not a reversal of, the sub-35% approval readings and high-single-digit Democratic generic-ballot edge this brief has carried since issue No. 26 — the news this week is that the edge survived a deliberate attempt to pollute the record, not that it moved.

Early voting adds a second, harder-to-fake data point: more than 30 million ballots had been cast nationally as of Oct. 26, running ahead of 2018 and 2022 turnout at the same point in the cycle, per AP- and NPR-sourced reporting. The state-level pattern argues against reading that as a uniform signal, however: Texas was running about 74% ahead of its 2022 pace, Ohio roughly 30% ahead, while Iowa was down about 6% — turnout enthusiasm is geographically lumpy, not a single national wave.

Read: none of this closes the gap this brief flagged in issue No. 32 between model-based and market-based election odds — one forecasting model still gives Democrats a 94.7% chance at the House and 62.1% at the Senate, while prediction-market pricing runs closer to 85% House and a near-coin-flip Senate. The fabricated-polling episode gives both camps a reason to distrust the other's inputs going into Tuesday, which is exactly the kind of uncertainty a market pricing a binary outcome does not like two days out. For this reader, the mechanism to watch isn't who wins so much as what combination

produces divided government: a Democratic House against any Senate outcome revives 2027 fiscal brinkmanship — shutdown and debt-ceiling leverage — as the default negotiating posture, while a Senate flip specifically slows the pace of Fed and judicial confirmations the administration has been pushing through on narrow margins. Watch: Tuesday's results; whether any further trackers claw back polls connected to Wedgewood or Median Strategies before voters go to the polls; and Monday's market open for the first sign of pre-election positioning.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Covered above in the Board — straits.live's latest reading (Day 245, 5:12a ET) shows no material change from Friday: the Crisis Pressure index is flat at 88 (Extreme) and the Escalation Forecast eased one point to 59 (Elevated). PortWatch's transit count remains frozen at 2 vessels on Oct. 25 against the 85/day baseline, now seven days without a revision — the longest stretch without an update this brief has carried. The dark-tanker share narrowed to 40.8% of 142 screened vessels from Friday's 53.8%, but non-tanker traffic went dark at a broadly similar 33.7% clip, which keeps this brief reading the screen as capturing ambient AIS dropout rather than a tanker-specific evasion signal. No new IRGC claim, UKMTO advisory, or diplomatic statement surfaced in this run's research; Araghchi's Oct. 18 conditional reopening offer remains unanswered as far as this brief can confirm.

SPORTS

Yankees	Season over; qualifying-offer call on Bednar reported, not confirmed.
Knicks	Record unconfirmed this run; host Brooklyn Monday.

Northwestern	Lost 34-14 at No. 4 Oregon Saturday — first-ever meeting between the programs.

Continuity. Politics, Economics and Business again fold into the Lead this weekend issue — the fake-polling scandal and early-voting data are this week's whole political story, and no market, macro or earnings news broke since Friday's close (issue No. 33). Technology and Business are dark until Monday's open. Watch for next issue: Monday's market reaction to Friday's rout; Palantir's print and whether AMD/Pfizer land Monday or Tuesday; the Knicks' still-unconfirmed record; Tuesday's midterm results; and whether straits.live republishes a clean dark-tanker baseline comparison.

Unverified figures are marked in red: the Knicks' current win-loss record; whether AMD reports Monday or Tuesday night; Palantir's Monday earnings date; the Bednar qualifying-offer decision and its $23.15M figure (single-sourced, Heyman/Sherman, New York Post); McMorrow's and the unnamed former candidate's claims about the Wedgewood scandal's campaign impact; OPEC+'s Nov. 1 output decision (outcome not published this run). Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.